Def.

A deformation retraction of a space X onto a subspace A is a family $\{ f_t : X \to X \mid t \in I \}$ satisfying $f_0 \equiv id$, $f_1[X] = A$, $f_t|_A \equiv id_A$ for all t, and $X \times I \to X : (x, t) \mapsto f_t(x)$ is continuous.